

Sessions Configuration

How to get started with using sessions for your website? Like in any other task in web development, the first step would be to configure it. Configuration set up is available at `config/session.php`. Laravel's session file is a well-documented one. Think of it as one giant ice cream store with a plethora of flavours for you to pick from. Depending on the type of application you are developing, you will need to pick the most suitable driver applicable. By default, session will try to use the file session driver. What is a driver, you might ask. When buying computer hardware, how often have you heard terms like disk-drive or hard-drive? As you might have deduced now, it is a program to control a device or a software.

Now that you have configured sessions, the next question is where will the sessions data be stored? Within the the session driver configuration option you can define where the data will be stored for each request.

Laravel ships with several great drivers out of the box:

- File - sessions are stored in `storage/framework/sessions`.
- Cookie - sessions are stored in secure, encrypted cookies.
- Database - sessions are stored in a relational database.
- Memcached / redis - sessions are stored in one of these fast, cache based stores.
- Array - sessions are stored in a PHP array and will not be persisted. (Persisted means that the characteristic of state that outlives the process that created it).

Caching Mechanism in Sessions

To explain setting up caching mechanism in a slight bit of depth while using sessions, let us talk about Memcached or redis. Both, Memcached or redis are two excellent examples free and open sourced cache brokers or cache based storehouses that are faster in performance and are the better option to file cache driver. Both can be used specifically in production applications as an option to the default of using sessions.

How to set up Redis?

You start with installing a package called `predis/predis`. This can be done by composer. To configure Redis, the database configuration file can be used. Redis connection can be selected in the session configuration file.